The pH Scale

A full-color guide to acids, neutral water, and bases

Approximate household examples · print in color for best results

ACIDIC | NEUTRAL | BASIC / ALKALINE

Acids: pH 0–6
Taste sour in foods like lemons.
Strong acids are not safe to touch.
Lower number = stronger acid.

Neutral: pH 7
Pure water is neutral.
It is not acidic or basic.
A helpful middle point.

Bases: pH 8–14
Often feel slippery in soaps.
Strong bases can burn skin.
Higher number = stronger base.

How to read a pH color test

1. Dip a pH strip into the liquid. Wait as directed on the strip package.
2. Match the strip color to the chart that came with your strips.

Important: pH paper brands use slightly different color charts. Use this poster as a learning guide.

Family science safety

Never taste mystery liquids. An adult should handle vinegar, cleaners, bleach, ammonia, and anything with a warning label.
Do not mix household cleaners. Bleach and ammonia should stay far apart.
For kid-friendly tests, use water, lemon juice, vinegar, baking soda solution, mild soap solution, or red cabbage indicator.

Little Lab Coats · hands-on science for homeschool families

© 2026 Little Lab Coats. Free for personal/family/classroom use. Please do not resell or redistribute as part of another product.

Science note: pH values for household materials are approximate and vary by product, concentration, and temperature.